# 2012 Honda Civic Hybrid

$5,542 · 173,579 miles · Dealer · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Compas Auto Sales (3.7 stars, 151 reviews)

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/JHMFB4F25CS001995/2012-honda-civic-hybrid-cvt-bakersfield-ca

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$6,404** | **$437** | **Average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 3/5 · 3 recalls · 456 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $5,542.00 |
| Sales tax (9.25%) | $512.63 |
| Dealer doc + filing fees | $125.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $36.02 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $6,403.66 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $1,403.66 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $28.13 |
| Total interest over the loan | $283.93 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $28.13 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 44 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $107.95 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $150.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $15.50 |
| Total per month | $436.58 |

Running costs without the loan: **$408/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$11,552** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Average (3/5)**

The 9th-gen (2012-15) Civic Hybrid's 1.5L engine and CVT are generally solid and it switched to a lithium-ion battery. Mileage puts the battery and CVT near the point where they need checking.

NHTSA data for this model year: 3 recalls · 456 owner complaints (55 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (149), Steering (74), Electrical System (60), Power Train (49), Service Brakes (39), Vehicle Speed Control (38).

**Known issues for this model**

• Hybrid (IMA) battery wear at high mileage

• CVT judder or slipping

• A/C compressor

• 12-volt battery drain

**Check on this car before buying**

• Hybrid battery health test; ask about IMA/battery history

• No IMA or check-engine lights; scan for stored codes

• CVT smooth from a stop, no shudder

• A/C cold

• Run VIN for open recalls

## Notes

$5,542 (about $6,329 out the door with fees), 173,579 mi. AutoCheck: clean title, accident-free, 1 previous owner, personal use. AutosToday: 24% below market (avg $7,271), 'Great buy'. Listed 2026-10-24.

44 MPG city/highway on regular gas - close to a Prius for DoorDash.

THE CATCH: the hybrid battery. 2012 was the first year Honda used a lithium-ion pack (more durable than the 2006-11 packs that failed a lot), but at 173k get a hybrid battery health check and ask if it was ever replaced. A new pack is roughly $3,000-4,000.

Dealer also has a 2005 Accord LX ($5,100, 127k) and 2006 Accord EX ($6,288, 143k) as non-hybrid backups (no history report shown for those).

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

[ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price

[ ] Recalls checked / completed

[ ] Clean title in seller's name

[ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills

[ ] No overheating; coolant clean

[ ] Pre-purchase inspection

[ ] VIN decoded & matches listing

[ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)

[ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)

[ ] A/C cold after 15+ min

[ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)

[ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.